



Delete specific history commands

We all know that while using Bash, the commands executed are stored, by default. To see these stored commands, we can run the following command at the terminal:

```
#history
```

To delete a specific command for the history, find the number associated with the command that we want to delete and then run the command shown below:

```
#history -d number
```

You can even clean the entire history by executing the following command:

```
#history -c
```

—Munish Kumar,
munishtotech@gmail.com



Search content with grep

If you want to find any particular word within a file, use the following command:

```
cd /  
grep -rn "searchstring" .
```

Please note there is a '.' (full stop) at the end, which tells *grep* to search recursively across folders:

```
cd /etc  
grep -rn "searchstring" .
```

This will search for a word under */etc*, recursively. This can be very useful in troubleshooting.

—Krishna Murthy Thimmaiah,
gtk321@rediffmail.com



Invert filtering by using grep

Here is a simple usage of *grep* that can invert the search pattern:

```
ps -ef | grep -v "root"
```

The first part, i.e., *ps -ef*, shows all the processes running on your system. If you want to see all the processes except those started by the root, use the '-v' option of the *grep* command, as above.

The '-v' option thus 'inverts' the search pattern.

—Lokesh Walase,
lokeshw24@gmail.com



Search your Bash history

We all know that Bash stores the commands that we run. Here is a tip to search for those commands from Bash history.

To search, you just have to press *CTRL* and the *R* key while you are logged in to the terminal.

You will get the following prompt in the terminal:

```
(reverse-i-search)'':
```

At this prompt, you can enter the part of the command that you want to search. This will immediately show you the searched command with all the parameters that were used when it was last run.

—Sanjeev Kulkarni,
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Sync and clear the cache

Most of us face memory utilisation issues to varying extents. Generally, we can see that the memory is used by the cache, so can we free it? Yes, we can. We can sync the cache and clear it, and in this way you will never lose any data. Although it's not an inbuilt program, it has been used by administrators for years. So, go clear your system's memory but don't forget to sync it.

```
#free -m ; sync ; echo 3 > /proc/sys/vm/drop_  
caches
```

—Lal Ashish,
lalahish@live.com



Extract email IDs from text files

Extracting email IDs manually from text files may be a tedious task but scripting makes it fun. Here is a simple script that can extract all email IDs and sort them alphabetically.

Execute the command given below and then check the output file for the email IDs:

```
#grep -oE [A-Za-z0-9_]*[.]?[A-Za-z0-9_]*@  
[A-Za-z0-9_]*[.]?[A-Za-z]* < emailstext.txt |  
sort -u >email.txt
```

Here, the input text file is named as *emailstext.txt* and the output is created in the file *email.txt*

—Suresh Jagtap,
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END

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